

York Stock Exchange has made a persistent and strenuous attempt to warn the investors of this country against security swindlers, and by close cooperation with government and private fraud-fighting bodies and institutions, to render the prosecution of security frauds more certain, more severe and more effective. Not until this most important task of fighting the security swindler and all his works is actively taken up by business men all over this country, can this constant and serious danger to stable business in this country be effectively eliminated.

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*For securities . . . represent a surplus, and in consequence the New York Stock Exchange represents a market for the national surplus of wealth.*

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Probably the most obvious service performed by the Stock Exchange in the interest of business stability consists in the high degree of ready marketability which it lends to the enormous aggregate amount of securities listed upon it. The market value of securities listed on the New York Stock Exchange at the present time totals nearly seventy billions of dollars—a sum approximately a quarter to a fifth of our total national wealth. On the whole, the New York Stock Exchange has been remarkably successful for over a century in this work of maintaining a reliable open market for the leading American securities. In connection with stabilizing business, this main function of the Stock Exchange—to render its listed securities always salable and purchasable—is exceedingly important. In the past, the panics in this country have not been due so much to any actual poverty or lack of property, as to a sudden illiquidity or unsalability of property. Due mainly to the New York Stock Exchange, stocks and bonds have proved the most readily salable commodity that we have. Time and again when raw materials, real estate